

Leading Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) providers like Workday, AppDynamics, Zendesk, HubSpot, Zenefits and GitHub bank on MySQL to run their businesses. MySQL is the technology of choice for some of the world's most popular unicorns, including DropBox, Line, Pinterest, Spotify, Yelp, Box, Ola, PayTM and InMobi, amongst others.

Q Is the open source community still important for MySQL? How has MySQL grown under Oracle's stewardship?

It's heartening to see strong open source adoption globally. Yes, the open source community is critical for the growth of and contribution to MySQL, given the large number of downloads every day.

Under the aegis of Oracle, MySQL has further grown in popularity, strength and capabilities. Delivery and security have become even better; MySQL is now secure, by default, when it is installed. There're a lot of mutual synergies. The vast majority of businesses that use Oracle solutions also use MySQL. And given Oracle's focus on embracing open source in a big way, it augurs well for MySQL.

Q How do you and your team continue to champion MySQL with the community?

In the data-driven world, MySQL is also evolving to remain the premier choice for Web-based applications. Part of this evolution involves actively engaging with the community through a number of initiatives: MySQL user conferences, webinars (live/on-demand), events, regular meetups and online forums/blogs. We receive a lot of code contributions, bug reports and feedback from the community. We have a dedicated group of engineers to actively address the needs and challenges of the community. The stewardship of Oracle has been appreciated by a lot of independent observers and people who have been a part of MySQL since the beginning.

Q What's your team's mantra for managing and developing MySQL?

Our aim is to provide the best experience of MySQL on the Oracle cloud. Additionally, with the popularity of the cloud, we are focusing on expanding product features and techniques to enable database administrators to get cloud databases up and running quickly and efficiently.

On the talent front, we are firm believers in a meritocracy. The hiring and growth of the team is based on wherever in the world we find the right capability. I am happy to share with you that India has our largest development centre.

“Mahindra Comviva, a subsidiary of Tech Mahindra and a part of the US\$ 19 billion Mahindra Group, was able to improve system performance by 50x and cut its customers' project costs by 5x by using the MySQL Enterprise Edition.”

Q How is business for MySQL growing? Where does India rank amongst all nations in terms of sales revenues?

We're growing at an impressive pace. Increasing cloud adoption and rising demand for modern developers have contributed to our growth. In India, we are working with a lot of leading public and private sector organisations and have a large footprint in the country. India is the fastest growing market for MySQL in the APAC region and our growth is showcased by the number of new clients we are adding to our portfolio. I want to highlight three examples here.

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Rehash, an alumnus of the Oracle Startup Cloud Accelerator programme, increased application performance by 3x by using Oracle MySQL. We've learnt that its stability and performance is at the best level it has ever been.

iTriangle, one of the leaders in the Indian vehicle telematics industry, leveraged Oracle MySQL Cloud Service along with Oracle cloud infrastructure to build a scalable, easy-to-manage and highly available platform.

In the public sector, we're an inherent part of several global, large scale government initiatives as well, including public identity and benefit programmes.

Q Has the business model for MySQL evolved over the years? If yes, how?

In the digital economy, the cloud has become a business imperative. MySQL has evolved to accommodate this shift, as companies look to transform into cloud-first businesses.

Our latest product, MySQL 8.0, caters to developers using both SQL and NoSQL technologies. Our recent focus has been on ensuring high availability with auto failover, and in helping businesses as well as developers in effectively managing a distributed database with multiple nodes.

Q How important is India in terms of influencing global sales—through the captive and independent design houses?

India is important both from a product development as well as market opportunity point of view. On the product development side, there's a lot of contribution from the India team across all areas of work. On the market opportunity front, we're doing a lot of interesting work with several government agencies.